LIBRARY CARD POLICY

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. YORK COUNTY LIBRARY CARDS
    1.1 Free to
    1.2 Out of County residents
    1.3 Allow users to:

2. RESPONSIBILITY OF CARD HOLDERS
    1.4 2.1 Patron agrees to
    1.5 2.2 To allow others access to their accounts
    1.6 2.3 Pre-authorization

3. ACCEPTABLE PROOF OF IDENTITY AND RESIDENCY
    3.1 Identification
    3.2 Proof of address

4. RESIDENT CARDS
    4.1 Full-time residence card
    4.2 Property owners living outside the county
    4.3 Out-of-county workers employed in York County
    4.4 Out-of-county college students
    4.5 Cards for minors (ages 0-17)

5. TEACHER CARDS
    5.1 Eligible teachers
    5.2 Benefits
    5.3 Restrictions

6. OUT OF COUNTY/NON-RESIDENT CARDS
    6.1 Renewal requirements

7. BORROWING PERIODS

8. CONFIDENTIALITY OF PATRON ACCOUNT INFORMATION

9. GENERAL POLICIES

10. REPLACEMENT OF LOST LIBRARY CARD

11. CHANGE OF CONTACT INFORMATION

12. APPENDIX I: CONFIDENTIALITY OF LIBRARY RECORDS

1. **YORK COUNTY LIBRARY CARDS (**Valid at all York County Libraries and the Bookmobile)

1.1 Free to: York County residents
York County property owners
Out-of-county residents employed in York County
Out-of-county college students with proper College ID

1.2 Available for an annual fee to out-of-county residents who do not work in York County.

1.3 Allow users to:

- Check out and place "Holds" on library materials
- Use public library computers
- Access online databases
- Provide free access to SCLENDS consortium holdings
- Provide access to request materials from libraries nationwide
- Review their account
- Search the catalog and databases
- Reserve materials from home, office, or school

2. **RESPONSIBILITIES OF CARD HOLDERS**

A library card establishes a financial account for which the user is responsible. The barcode on a library card uniquely identifies the user in both YCL and SCLENDS systems.

2.1 By signing the application, the patron agrees to**:**

- Follow all library policies and procedures
- Return all borrowed materials
- Pay for replacement of lost or damaged items or components
- Accept the authority of library personnel and the Board of Trustees in enforcing policies
- When signing for a juvenile's card, the parent or legal guardian agrees to:
    - Supervise the child's library use and be responsible for library materials obtained with that card
    - Be responsible for fines and fees generated by loaning their card or allowing others to use it
    - Report lost or stolen cards immediately

2.2 To allow others access to their account, cardholders must:

- Pre-authorize individuals by adding their names to the library record
- Ensure those individuals present picture ID
- A cardholder may give their physical card to another person to authorize access

2.3 Pre-authorization or presentation of another's card is required to provide the following information to anyone other than the cardholder:

- Whether the person is registered for a card
- Whether fines or fees exist, including amounts and payment status
- What items are checked out and when they are due
- What hold or interlibrary loan titles are available for pickup

3. ACCEPTABLE PROOF OF IDENTITY AND RESIDENCY

All applicants must provide current proof of identity and residency. Staff may determine whether documentation sufficiently proves both name and address.

3.1 Identification: Picture ID must be current and unexpired

- Current driver's license
- Current South Carolina Department of Highways ID
- Current employer or military picture ID
- Current school picture ID
- Current consular ID
- Current passport

3.2 Proof of Address

- Current picture ID with current address
- Current bank/check statement
- Current tax notice
- Current utility bill
- York County voter registration card
- Current rent receipt

4. RESIDENT CARDS

4.1. Resident card requires proof of current York County residence and must live in York County at least 6 months per year.

4.2. Property owners living outside the county must provide:

- York County tax receipt
- Proof of identity

- Proof of current address
- Accounts expire every two years and may be renewed with updated tax receipt

4.3. Out-of-county workers employed in York County must provide:

- Employer-issued ID or business card
- Proof of identity
- Proof of current address

4.4. Out-of-county students enrolled in a college located in York County must provide:

- Current college ID

4.5 Cards for minors ages 0–17: Applications must be completed and signed by a parent or legal guardian.

- Parent/Guardian must choose one of the following card types:
    - Children Card (Ages 0–12)
        - Standard checkout limits
        - May borrow juvenile materials only
        - Access to public computers and online databases
        - No Interlibrary Loan access
    - Teen Card (Ages 13–17)
        - Standard checkout limits
        - May borrow juvenile and teen materials only
        - Access to public computers and online databases
        - No Interlibrary Loan access
    - Unrestricted Minor Card
        - Standard checkout limits
        - May borrow juvenile, teen, and adult materials
        - Access to public computers, online databases, and digital materials

Cards for minors (ages 0-17) expire when the child turns 18. They must apply for an adult card under their own signature. Any outstanding fines or fees on the minor's card transfer to the new resident card.

5. TEACHER CARDS

Available to residents and non-residents who teach in York County schools.

5.1 Eligible teachers include:

- Public school teachers
- Private school teachers
- Daycare providers
- Homeschooling parents or legal guardians

5.2 Benefits:

- 4-week checkout period instead of 2 weeks
- Up to 100 items checked out at one time

5.3 Restrictions:

- No renewals
- Interlibrary loan materials may not be checked out
- Rental items may not be checked out
- Bestsellers may not be checked out
- These restricted items must be checked out on the teacher's regular patron card
- Interlibrary loan exclusions follow the lending library's policies
- Rental items and bestsellers excluded due to high demand

6. OUT-OF-COUNTY / NON-RESIDENT CARDS

Available to out-of-county or non-residents for an annual fee of $35.00.

Provides the same borrowing privileges as resident cards.

Fee amount may change yearly.

Cards expire at the end of each year.

6.1 Renewal requirements:

- New application
- Proof of identity
- Proof of address
- Payment of annual fee

Card Type	Item Limit	Maximum Renewals
Resident	30	2*
Teacher	100**	0
Out-of-County/Non-Resident	30	2*

Card Type	Item Limit	Maximum Renewals

*Maximum renewals are subject to availability based on holds
**Excludes interlibrary loan materials, rentals, and bestsellers

7. BORROWING PERIODS

1-Week Checkout: DVDs (limit 10)

2-Week Checkout: Hotspots, New items, Video games (limit 2)

3-Week Checkout: All other items

8. CONFIDENTIALITY OF PATRON ACCOUNT INFORMATION

Patron records are protected by South Carolina state statutes (Appendix I)

Records are held in strict confidence by library staff

No one may access a cardholder's account without:

- Pre-authorized consent from the cardholder
- Required legal documents for law enforcement

9. GENERAL POLICIES

Cards signed by a person must be in good standing (no blocks or charges) before new cards are issued with the exception of cards for minor children they are legally responsible for.

Cardholder contact information is verified and updated annually.

Library cards expire every two years. Renewal requires new application and proof of identity and residency.

Renewal may also be completed online or by phone.

No reciprocal borrowing agreements with neighboring counties except SCLENDS members.

York County cardholders in good standing may check out and return materials at any SCLENDS library.

10. REPLACEMENT OF LOST LIBRARY CARD

Lost or stolen cards must be reported immediately. Failure to report results in responsibility for all use, fines, and fees incurred after loss.

Replacement fees apply for:

- Lost cards
- Stolen cards
- Cards damaged through negligence
- Cards worn out through normal wear and tear are replaced at no cost

11. CHANGE OF CONTACT INFORMATION

Updates should be made as soon as possible. Failure to update may result in missed notices (overdue, lost item, holds, etc.). Library is not responsible for fines or fees caused by outdated contact information.

Cardholders must update their name, address, phone numbers, and email address.

12. APPENDIX I: CONFIDENTIALITY OF LIBRARY RECORDS

The following is quoted from the State of South Carolina online website at www.scstatehouse.gov. However, the website should be accessed directly for the most up-to-date version and related information.

TITLE 60. LIBRARIES, ARCHIVES, MUSEUMS, AND ARTS
CHAPTER 4. CONFIDENTIAL LIBRARY RECORDS

SECTION 60-4-10. Records identifying library patrons as confidential information; disclosure. [SC ST SEC 60-4-10]

Records related to registration and circulation of library materials which contain names or other personally identifying details regarding the users of public, private, school, college, technical college, university, and state institutional libraries and library systems, supported in whole or in part by public funds or expending public funds, are confidential information.

Records which by themselves or when examined with other public records would reveal the identity of the library patron checking out or requesting an item from the library or using other library services are confidential information.

The confidential records do not include nonidentifying administrative and statistical reports of registration and circulation.

The confidential records may not be disclosed except to persons acting within the scope of their duties in the administration of the library or library system or persons authorized by the library patron to inspect his records, or in accordance with proper judicial order upon a finding that the disclosure of the records is necessary to protect public safety, to prosecute a crime, or upon showing of good cause before the presiding Judge in a civil matter.

SECTION 60-4-20. Definitions. [SC ST SEC 60-4-20]

As used in this chapter, the term "registration records" includes any information which a library requires a patron to provide in order to become eligible to borrow books and other materials, and the term "circulation records" includes all information which identifies the patrons borrowing particular books and other materials.

SECTION 60-4-30. Penalties. [SC ST SEC 60-4-30]

Any person violating the provisions of § 60-4-10 must upon conviction be fined not more than five hundred dollars or imprisoned for not more than thirty days for the first offense, must be fined not more than one thousand dollars or imprisoned for not more than sixty days for the second offense, and must be fined not more than two thousand dollars or imprisoned for not more than ninety days for the third or subsequent offense.